month back. From then onwards Sodhi had been keeping a close watch on the man's activities. Given the sensitivity of this information, I requested Sodhi to join me for lunch, where I wanted him to meet some important persons. As his flight back to Toronto was not until late afternoon, he agreed to accompany me. I booked a table for five for lunch at a Chinese restaurant on the ground floor of the building where the Permanent Mission of India to the United Nations was located.

Keeping in view Trivedi's uncalled-for snide remarks, I contacted Subhash Tandon by phone and informed him that I would like him to meet someone who had information relating to a threat to Indira Gandhi's life. Tandon was busy and so sent Trivedi and Sahgal to meet us at the restaurant. On our way there I told Sodhi that we would be meeting two senior officers from the IB who, as members of prime minister's security detail, had been on duty that morning.

Soon after we arrived at the restaurant, Trivedi and Sahgal joined us. I introduced them to Sodhi. Both were familiar with his name and the position he held in Jagjit Singh Chauhan's set-up at Toronto. Frail, five-foot eight inches tall, fair-complexioned and with a thin, greying beard, Sodhi did not fit the image of someone involved in pro-Khalistan activities. A little later, pointing towards Trivedi, I told Sodhi that he didn't believe there was any threat to Indira Gandhi's life during her visit to the gurudwara that morning. I requested him to share with them what he had told me earlier.

Everyone listened to him in rapt attention and in total silence. No questions were asked. Afterwards, I took Sodhi in a cab to drop him at LaGuardia airport so he could catch his flight to Toronto. I asked him how his 'business' was doing. He replied that thanks to Indira Gandhi's mishandling of the situation in Punjab, a fairly large number of Sikhs in Canada and the US had started believing in what his organization had been propagating so far. In a mischievous tone, he asked me to convey their special thanks to her for all that she was doing in Punjab.

After dropping Sodhi at the airport, I sent a message to Suntook about what had happened during the day. I left for Los Angeles on the afternoon of 2 August, to reach the Holiday Inn hotel an hour or